BOOK ECONOMY

MARKETS, TAX & FX

Your country's market and the global market, listing rules, taxes and tariffs, donations, and the currency exchange.

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MARKETS

Goods are traded on two markets run entirely by players. No algorithm sets prices. If bread is expensive, it is because players priced it that way — and that is your opening to undercut them.

YOUR COUNTRY'S MARKET

The **Market** page is the market of the country you are a citizen of, wherever you happen to stand. Only that country's citizens see it, list on it and buy from it; a citizen of an independent region (no state yet) has no country market.

- Prices are in the country's own currency.
- The buyer pays the listed price; the seller receives it minus the country's **income tax**.

THE GLOBAL MARKET

The **Global Market** is open to every player, and prices are in **gold**.

- The buyer pays the **import tax** of their own country on top of the price; the seller loses the **export tax** of their own country from the proceeds. Both go to the two treasuries in gold, on every global trade — even between citizens of the same country. Each offer shows its **landed cost**: the ask plus your import tax.
- A **trade agreement** waives the import tax on purchases between the two countries, in both directions; the export tax still applies.
- An **embargo** hides the two countries' listings from each other's citizens, and neither side can buy across it.

- An **export ban** stops a country's citizens from listing that item on the global market or adding stock to a listing of it. Passing the ban takes their live listings of it off the market, returns the goods to the sellers and tells them. Raws, food, weapons, tickets, energy drinks, components and ships can all be banned. The ban touches neither your country's own market nor buying from abroad, but it also stops the item leaving the country by contract.
- Each item and tier shows its **100 cheapest** offers.

The frontier levy. Citizens of an **independent region** (no state yet) can buy and sell on the global market too. In place of a state's import or export tax a flat **10% frontier levy** applies to their side of every trade — added on top when they buy, deducted when they sell — and no treasury collects it. Parliament rates and trade agreements never apply to the frontier, so founding a state still pays. Their listings show "Independent" instead of a flag; export bans and embargoes do not touch them.

LISTING RULES

These rules hold on both markets:

- **Minimum size.** A listing starts at **100 units** for raw materials, **10** for food, weapons and tickets, **10** for components and **1** for ships. Energy drinks cannot be listed on either market — trade them by contract.
- **One listing per item and tier** on each market. Listing again at the same price adds to your open listing, which keeps its original 72-hour clock; at a different price the listing is refused — edit the one you have instead.
- **Every listing lives 72 hours.** Unsold stock returns to your inventory automatically, with a notification — nothing rots in the book. Returns never go past your storage cap: whatever does not fit stays listed for another 72 hours, and the notice tells you how much.
- **Editing a listing.** Change a listing's price or stock from *My listings*, then wait **5 minutes** before editing it again. An edit does not extend the 72 hours, and the new stock must still meet the minimum size. Raising the stock takes the extra units from your storage; lowering it must fit back on your shelf, or the edit is refused. An export ban blocks raising stock on the global market.
- **Cancelling returns what fits.** A cancel hands back only what fits in your storage and leaves the rest listed; with no room at all, it is refused.
- **Relist cooldown.** After you cancel a listing, that item and tier wait **5 minutes** before you can list them again. Sales and 72-hour expiries never start a cooldown — only your own cancel does.

Buying. You can buy part of a listing or all of it. A purchase is refused when the goods would not fit in your storage, when the price changed since you looked (look again and decide), and on your own listings. The seller is notified of every sale. Each market page also shows a price-history chart and the latest fills.

My trades. The **My trades** button on both market pages opens your ledger: your last 200 fills on both markets — date, side, item, market, quantity, price, total, the tax you paid and the other party — with a total per item of what you spent, what you earned and the difference.

TAXES AND TARIFFS

Every state sets four rates by law: the **Economy minister** or the **president** can enact a new rate directly, and otherwise parliament votes on it. A new state starts at **10%** on all four, and every rate stays within **0–50%**:

- **Income tax** — withheld from wages when you work, and taken from what you earn selling on your country's market.
- **Production tax** — on RAW output only (manufactured goods pay none), taken **in kind** into the state treasury's resource stores.
- **Import tax** — paid by the buyer, on top, on every global-market purchase, to the buyer's state.
- **Export tax** — deducted from the seller's proceeds on every global-market sale, to the seller's state.

A tax is computed as $\lfloor \text{amount} \cdot \text{rate} \rfloor$. Money taxes (income tax and the global-market taxes) owe at least **0.01** of the currency or gold on any positive taxed amount, so nothing taxable slips through at zero; the production tax has no such minimum — it is a plain round-down.

Currency exchange and contracts pay no tax at all.

DONATIONS

Any player can gift a state from its country page: **gold** and **money** land in the treasury (logged as donations), **raw resources** in the state storage — the same stores that taxes feed. The country page ranks its top donors. Patriotism, war chests, bribes… the ledger doesn't judge.

CURRENCY & FX

Gold is the universal, cross-border money. Next to it, every state uses one of ten currencies: **USD, EUR, GBP, TRY, INR, BRL, CNY, JPY, ZAR** and **SEK**. Several states can share a currency, and a newly formed state starts on USD. Companies in independent regions pay wages in USD.

A state changes its currency by law — the president enacts it directly, or parliament votes it — at most **once every 30 days**, and only to a currency already in use in the world. Every open listing on that country's market is cancelled and the goods go back to their sellers.

THE MINT

The mint turns **1 gold into 10** of any of the ten currencies, in any amount, at any time. It only works one way: currency becomes gold again only on the exchange.

THE EXCHANGE

On the **FX** page players trade currencies against gold, with no tax and no fee:

- **Two order walls** per currency — *Gold for sale* (players selling gold, cheapest first) and *Gold wanted* (players buying gold, highest bid first). Equal rates go to the older order, and each wall shows its best 100 offers.
- **Rate-first orders** — you choose a direction, a whole amount of gold (1 lot = 1 gold) and a rate in local currency per gold. Listing an order places everything you offer in escrow. You can hold one open order per currency and direction; every order **expires after 72 hours**, and whatever is still unfilled comes back to you in full.
- **Taking an offer** — take any number of its lots; you cannot take your own.
- **A far-off rate asks twice.** Taking an offer above **20** or below **5** per gold — more than double or less than half the mint's 1 gold = 10 — asks you to confirm first. So does listing an order that sells gold below 5 or buys it above 20.
- **Relist cooldown** — cancel an order and that currency and direction wait **5 minutes** before you can place a new one. Fills and expiries never start the cooldown.
- **Two live charts** track gold sales and gold purchases separately.
- **My orders** always shows every open order you have, in every currency, with **filled / total lots**, the **amount held in escrow**, a countdown and a cancel button. A partly filled order is never lost — the remainder simply waits in the book. Every fill records both parties.

GOVERNMENT ORDERS

Below the walls you see your own state's **treasury orders** for that currency — no other country's, and none at all while you have no state. A treasury order is placed by law — the Economy minister enacts it directly, or parliament votes it — with at most one buy-gold and one sell-gold order per currency; a new law replaces the standing one, and a removal law clears it. Treasury orders never expire, are backed live by the treasury rather than escrow, and a fill the treasury cannot cover at that moment is refused.

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